

Laptop Prep for “Hands-on: Time Series Forecasting with Python”

Introduction

Thank you for registering for Day 3 of my 3-day Machine Learning Bootcamp!

There are a few things that I want to mention to help you prepare for the course:

- NOTE – This course assumes you know decision trees and random forest machine learning. If you do not, please register for Day 1 of the Bootcamp to get this knowledge.
- If you're new to Python, TDWI will send you a link to my free Python Quick Start online tutorial. This will cover everything you need to know before class.
- If you're attending other courses in the ML Bootcamp, you will receive a laptop prep document like this one for each course.
- If you're attending all three days of the ML Bootcamp, you will receive my Introduction to Machine Learning course as a gift. TDWI will email you a link after the Bootcamp.
- If you would like to enroll in all three days of the Bootcamp, but are not, drop an email to info@tdwi.org.

I look forward to seeing you in class.

-Dave

Overview

Laptop preparation for the class consists of four steps, with detailed instructions below:

1. Download course files from GitHub
2. Installation of Anaconda Python
3. Installation of the skforecast Python package
4. Verify installation

NOTE – When using a work laptop, please keep the following in mind:

- Administrator permission may be required to complete laptop prep.
- It is often necessary to disable anti-virus software to allow for the installation. As such, disabling any anti-virus is recommended before laptop prep.
- Corporate proxy servers and firewalls can block the installation. Be sure to consult your IT department as needed.
- Lastly, installing the version of Anaconda Python listed below is highly recommended, even if you have Python already installed. The course has been tested only with the version listed below.

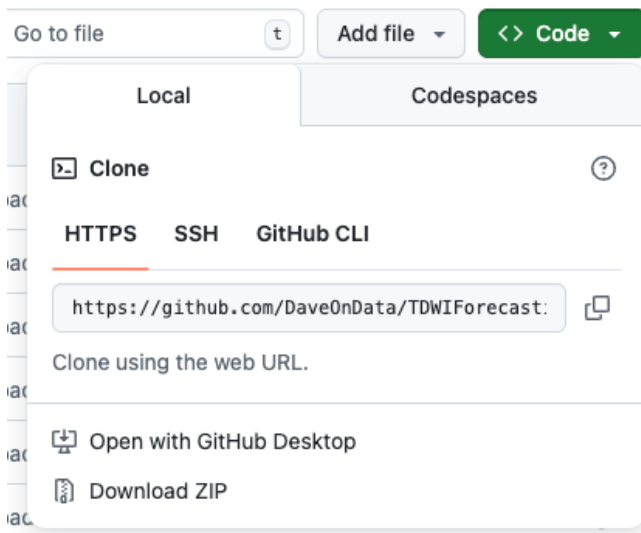
Because of the above, many attendees find using their personal laptop for the course is an easier option.

Hardware Requirements

1. Windows or Mac OS X preferred (instructors have no experience with Linux)
2. 64-bit operating system
3. 8GB of RAM, 16GB preferred
4. 5GB of free drive space

Step 1 - Download the files from GitHub

1. The GitHub repository with all required course files is located here:
 - a. <https://github.com/DaveOnData/TDWIForecastingWithPython>
2. Within the GitHub repository page, click on the “Code” button and select “Download ZIP”:



3. Copy the file folder within the downloaded ZIP to a well-known location on your laptop (e.g., the Desktop):



4. Open the file folder. You should see the following files:

- BikeSharing_Test.csv
- BikeSharing_Train.csv
- BikeSharing_Validation.csv
- Hands-On Lab 1 - Baseline.ipynb
- Hands-On Lab 2 - Evaluation.ipynb
- Hands-On Lab 3 - Lags.ipynb
- Hands-On Lab 4 - Feature Engineering.ipynb
- Hands-On Lab 5 - Tuning and Testing.ipynb
- LaptopPrepForecastingWithPython.pdf
- README.md

Step 2 – Anaconda Python Installation

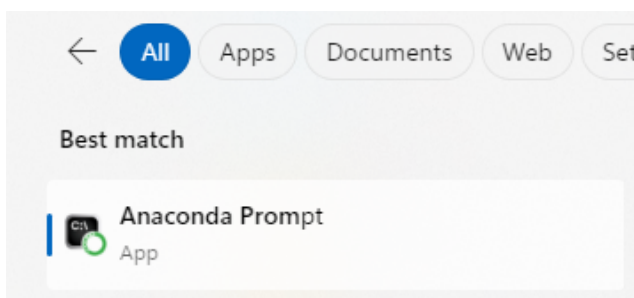
1. Click the link below for your operating system to download the Anaconda installer:
 - Windows: https://repo.anaconda.com/archive/Anaconda3-2025.06-1-Windows-x86_64.exe
 - Mac (Apple CPU): <https://repo.anaconda.com/archive/Anaconda3-2025.06-1-MacOSX-arm64.pkg>
 - Mac (Intel CPU): https://repo.anaconda.com/archive/Anaconda3-2025.06-1-MacOSX-x86_64.pkg

NOTE – The above versions might not be the latest Anaconda distribution at the time of the ML Bootcamp. The course has been tested with this version only. Also, if you installed the 2025.06 version of Anaconda as part of the Python Quick Start, you do not need to install it again.

2. When the installer has downloaded, start the installer and follow the instructions (accepting defaults) to complete the installation.

Step 3 – skforecast Installation

1. This course uses the powerful skforecast package. However, this package is not installed by default with Anaconda.
2. With Anaconda Python installed, start the Anaconda Prompt:



NOTE – On Mac, use the Terminal app. The commands are the same.

3. At the command prompt, type the following without quotes and hit <enter>:
 - a. "conda install -c conda-forge skforecast"

 Anaconda Prompt

```
(base) C:\Users\david>conda install -c conda-forge skforecast
```

4. If prompted, hit the "y" key and <enter> to proceed:

```
Anaconda Prompt - conda install -c conda-forge skforecast

certifi-2025.10.5      | pyhd8ed1ab_0      156 KB  conda-forge
colorlog-6.9.0        | pyh7428d3b_1      16 KB   conda-forge
conda-25.7.0          | py313hfa70ccb_0    1.2 MB  conda-forge
mako-1.3.10           | pyhd8ed1ab_0       66 KB   conda-forge
openssl-3.1.0         | hcfcfb64_3         7.1 MB  conda-forge
optuna-4.5.0          | pyhd8ed1ab_0      241 KB  conda-forge
skforecast-0.18.0     | pyhd8ed1ab_0      416 KB  conda-forge
ucrt-10.0.26100.0     | h57928b3_0         678 KB  conda-forge
-----
Total:                10.1 MB

The following NEW packages will be INSTALLED:

alembic      conda-forge/noarch::alembic-1.17.0-pyhd8ed1ab_0
colorlog     conda-forge/noarch::colorlog-6.9.0-pyh7428d3b_1
mako         conda-forge/noarch::mako-1.3.10-pyhd8ed1ab_0
optuna       conda-forge/noarch::optuna-4.5.0-pyhd8ed1ab_0
skforecast   conda-forge/noarch::skforecast-0.18.0-pyhd8ed1ab_0
ucrt         conda-forge/win-64::ucrt-10.0.26100.0-h57928b3_0

The following packages will be UPDATED:

ca-certificates  pkgs/main/win-64::ca-certificates-202~ --> conda-forge/noarch::ca-certificates-2025.10.5-h4c7d964_0
certifi          pkgs/main/win-64::certifi-2025.4.26-p~ --> conda-forge/noarch::certifi-2025.10.5-pyhd8ed1ab_0
conda            pkgs/main::conda-25.5.1-py313haa95532~ --> conda-forge::conda-25.7.0-py313hfa70ccb_0
openssl          pkgs/main::openssl-3.0.16-h3f729d1_0 --> conda-forge::openssl-3.1.0-hcfcfb64_3

Proceed ([y]/n)?
```

5. When the installation is completed, you should see something like the following (NOTE – This can take quite a while to run end-to-end):

 Anaconda Prompt

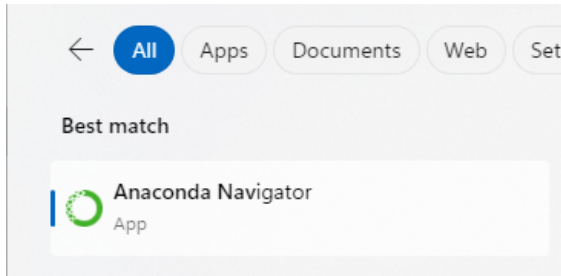
```
Downloading and Extracting Packages:

Preparing transaction: done
Verifying transaction: done
Executing transaction: done

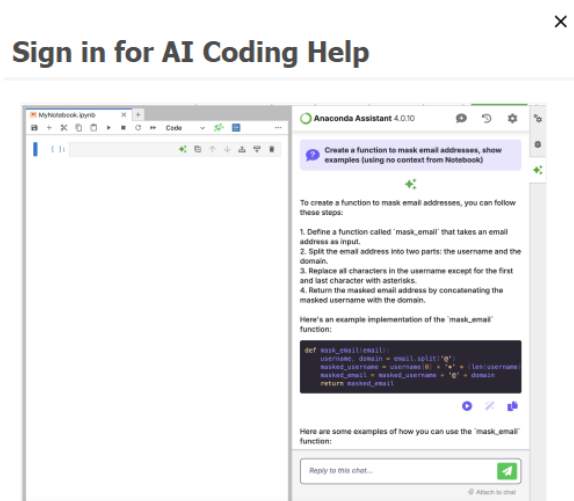
(base) C:\Users\david>
```

Step 4 – Verify Installation

1. With Anaconda Python installed, start the Anaconda Navigator application:



2. If you see the following dialog, close it (no need to sign in):



Access Anaconda Assistant in Jupyter Notebooks and JupyterLab.

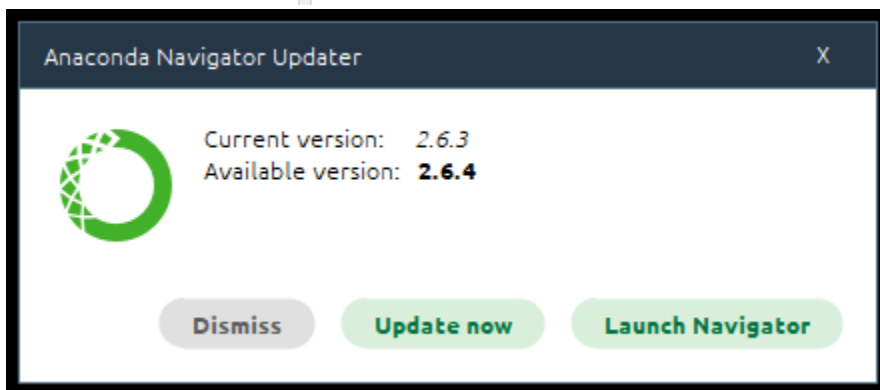
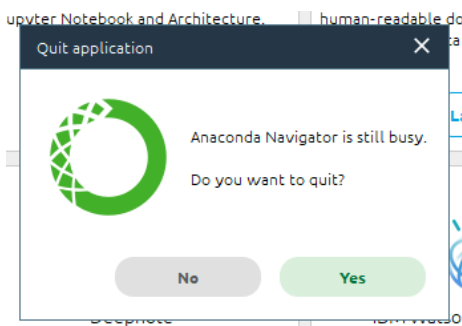
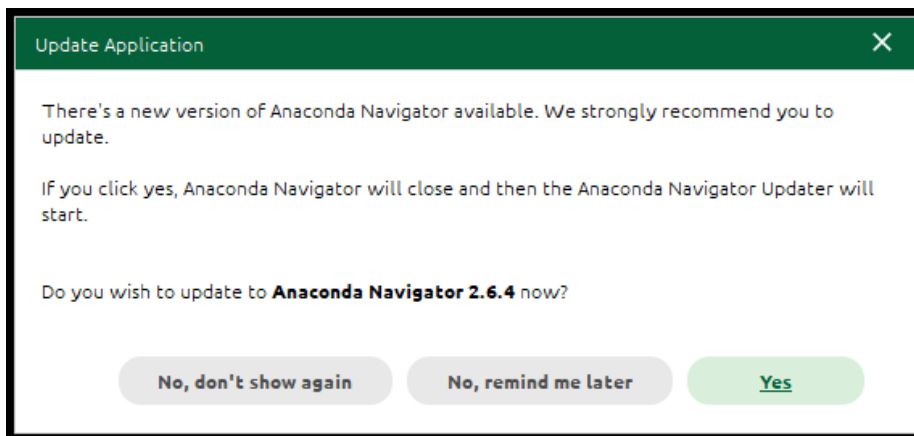
☐ Do not show again

[Connect to a Repository](#)

[Sign In](#)

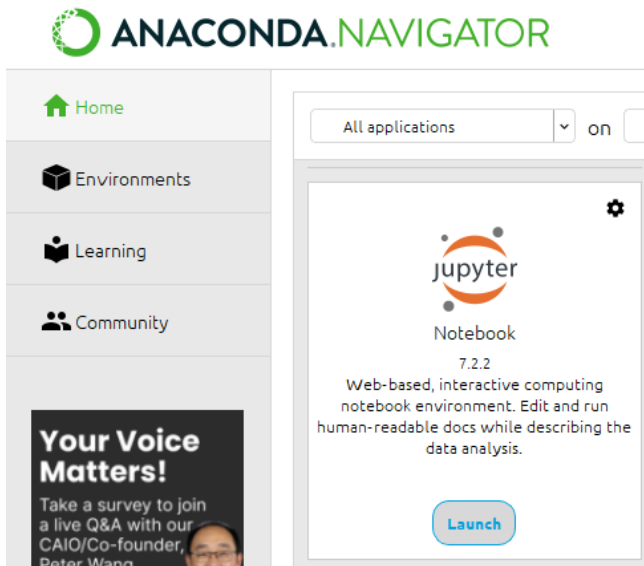
Don't have an account? [Sign Up](#)

3. You may be prompted to upgrade Anaconda Navigator. Follow the dialogs (i.e., click “Yes” and “Update now”) to do so. It may take a bit of time for this process to complete.

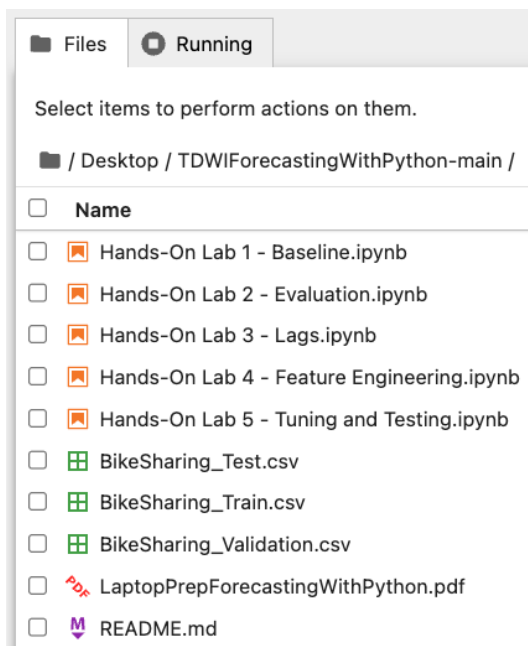


4. If needed, relaunch Anaconda Navigator.

5. NOTE – Your Anaconda Navigator window might not look exactly like the following. Within Anaconda Navigator, launch Jupyter Notebook:



6. Within the Jupyter browser, navigate to where you copied the course file folder:



Congratulations! You are now ready for the class!